

5K Training Plan

24-Week Extended Beginner Program

Program Details

Distance:	5 kilometers (3.1 miles)
Duration:	24 weeks
Level:	Beginner
Training Days:	3-4 days per week

Program Overview

This 24-week extended beginner 5K training plan is designed for complete beginners who want a very gradual, low-pressure approach to running. The extended timeline allows for more recovery time between progressions.

Training Phases

- Weeks 1-6: Foundation Phase - Walking and very light run/walk intervals
- Weeks 7-12: Base Building Phase - Gradually increase running intervals
- Weeks 13-18: Development Phase - Build continuous running ability
- Weeks 19-23: Peak Phase - Longer runs with some speed work
- Week 24: Race Week - Taper and race day

Weekly Training Schedule

Week 1							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1	Walk	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk
	20m		20m		25m		30m

Week 2							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
2	Walk	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk
Week 3							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
3	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk
Week 4							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
4	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk
Week 5							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
5	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk
Week 6							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
6	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk
Week 7							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
7	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 8							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
8	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest
	6x90s	20m		6x90s		8x90s	

Week 9							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
9	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 10							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
10	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 11							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
11	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 12							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
12	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 13							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
13	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 14							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
14	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 15							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
15	Easy	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Rest	Easy	Rest
	12m	35m		2x12m		18m	

Week 16							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
16	Easy	Cross	Rest	Easy	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 17							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
17	Easy	Cross	Rest	Easy	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 18							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
18	Easy	Cross	Rest	Easy	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 19							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
19	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 20							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
20	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 21							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
21	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 22							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
22	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Rest	Easy	Rest
	2.5mi	45m		10m+4x1m		3mi	

Week 23							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
23	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Rest	Easy	Rest
Week 24							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
24	Easy	Cross	Rest	Easy	Rest	Rest	5K RACE
	2mi	30m		15m+			
				strides			

Workout Definitions

Walk: Brisk walking at a pace that elevates your heart rate slightly.

Walk/Run: Alternate between running and walking for the specified intervals.

Easy Run: Run at a comfortable, conversational pace.

Cross Training: Low-impact cardio such as cycling, swimming, or elliptical.

Speed Work: Higher intensity intervals at a challenging but sustainable pace.